Detroit-Style Pizza

Main dishes | Oven

Before you start

Makes three 10x14-inch pizzas. Give the dough 1-2 days to cold-ferment in the pans, then finish each pizza with a five-minute par-bake and a short final bake.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Flour and salt

Bowl B - Warm water and yeast

Bowl C - Sauce garlic, oregano, and pepper flakes

Bowl D - Sauce tomatoes, garlic powder, onion powder, sugar, and salt

Dough

- [ ] 1050 g bread flour [Bowl A]
- [ ] 30 g kosher salt [Bowl A]
- [ ] 765 g water, warmed to 85-95F [Bowl B]
- [ ] 10.5 g instant dried yeast [Bowl B]

For the pans and topping

- [ ] Butter or shortening, to grease three 10x14-inch pans
- [ ] 48 oz cheese total (16 oz per pizza): brick cheese preferred; white cheddar, Jack, or Havarti also work; mozzarella optional
- [ ] Fresh basil, chopped
- [ ] Pepperoni or other toppings (optional)

Kenji's sauce

- [ ] 2 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- [ ] 3 medium garlic cloves, minced [Bowl C]
- [ ] 2 tsp dried oregano [Bowl C]
- [ ] Dash red pepper flakes [Bowl C]
- [ ] 1 28-oz can high-quality crushed tomatoes [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1 tsp granulated garlic powder [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1 tsp granulated onion powder [Bowl D]
- [ ] 1 tbsp sugar [Bowl D]

- [ ] Kosher salt, to taste [Bowl D]

1. Mix and start the dough

1. Combine 1050 g bread flour and 30 g kosher salt in a stand mixer fitted with a dough hook.

2. Stir 10 1/2 g instant yeast into 765 g warm water (85-95°F); wait 5 minutes. Add slowly while mixing on low about 10 minutes until smooth, very wet, and sticky. Scrape the bowl as needed.

3. With wet hands, fold the dough into a ball. Cover and leave at room temperature 1-2 hours to begin fermentation; it should rise somewhat but does not need to double.

2. Pan and cold-ferment

1. Divide the rested dough into 3 equal balls. Grease three 10x14-inch Detroit-style pans with butter or shortening.

2. Place one dough ball in each pan. With wet hands, flatten and stretch it as close to the edges as possible. Cover the pans and refrigerate 1-2 days.

3. Prepare for baking

1. Bring the pans to room temperature for 3 hours. Preheat a home oven to 550F. For an outdoor pizza oven, preheat to 700-800F for about 20 minutes.

2. Let each dough rest in its pan 30 minutes, then stretch again so it reaches every edge. Par-bake each pizza on the bottom of a home oven for 5 minutes.

4. Make Kenji's sauce

1. Warm 2 tbsp olive oil in a saucepan. Add 3 minced medium garlic cloves, 2 tsp dried oregano, and a dash of red pepper flakes; cook just until fragrant.

2. Stir in one 28 oz can crushed tomatoes, 1 tsp garlic powder, 1 tsp onion powder, 1 tbsp sugar, and kosher salt to taste. Simmer until slightly thickened; cool enough to spoon onto the pizzas. Sauce may be made ahead and refrigerated.

5. Top, bake, and serve

1. Top each pizza with 16 oz cheese (48 oz total across 3 pizzas): mozzarella first if using, then cubed or shredded brick cheese to the edges. Spoon the prepared sauce in wide stripes; add pepperoni or other optional toppings to taste.

2. For a home oven, return the pizza to the bottom rack for about 7 minutes. Broil for the last 1-2 minutes only if the cheese or pepperoni needs more browning. For an outdoor pizza oven, bake 5-6 minutes, rotate halfway through, and cover with foil if it browns too quickly.

3. Run a thin metal spatula around the edges, slide the pizza onto a wire rack, rest 3 minutes, finish with basil, and slice.

Notes

This preserves the saved personal pan-first workflow: divide into three dough balls and spread into pans before the 1-2 day cold ferment.

The original Pala Pizza method uses the same dough formula for one 10x14-inch pizza; the saved document scales it to three pans. The par-bake-and-freeze question in the source document remains an experiment, not an adopted step.